

Darwin Core Maintenance Group call

2026-10-05 12:30 UTC

Attendees: John Wieczorek, Steve Baskauf, Cecilie Svenningsen, Erica Krimmel, Pieter Huybrechts, Kit Lewers, Paula Zermoglio, Peter Desmet, Jörg Holetschek, Ben Norton

Regrets: Tim Robertson

The next meeting should be on 2 November 2026 (the first Monday) at 12:30 UTC.

- I. Ongoing public review (see https://dwc.tdwg.org/public_review/ :
 - A. The review period has closed with no additional dissent on the issues that passed the initial 30 days.
 - B. The proposals should go to the Executive Committee at their October 13 meeting.
 - C. John W. has reworked the pipeline for updates post review, now much easier.
- II. Public meeting notes
 - A. For reference, the process used in Audiovisual Core was to generate a pdf from the meeting Google Doc, then push it to GitHub. See <https://github.com/tdwg/ac/tree/master/historical> for examples. This made the notes available in a non-mutable form without the requirement to share the original Google Docs.
 1. Peter: Is there demand for this? Want to make sure we don't invest time in things for which there is no demand. If we want to clarify that no secret decisions are made, then having a document stating what the maintenance group does is maybe more important (<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/1062>). In addition, I think we should have clearer changelogs (e.g. at <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/releases/tag/2023-07-10>).
 - B. This could easily be done if we continue the current practice of putting the meeting notes in a separate doc as we have been doing (not so easy for a continually extended single meeting notes document as is done by other groups).
Conducted a test and pdfs are still rendered on the GitHub website when the file page is viewed.
- III. Convenership
 - A. This will be Steve's last meeting as convener. John will resume as convener in November.
- IV. Determining issues to move forward into the November public review
 - A. We are starting the first regular review of the thrice per year release cycle, with the public review to start November 1.
 - B. Our task as a group is to approve change requests to be included in the review based on their meeting the demand, efficacy, and stability criteria.

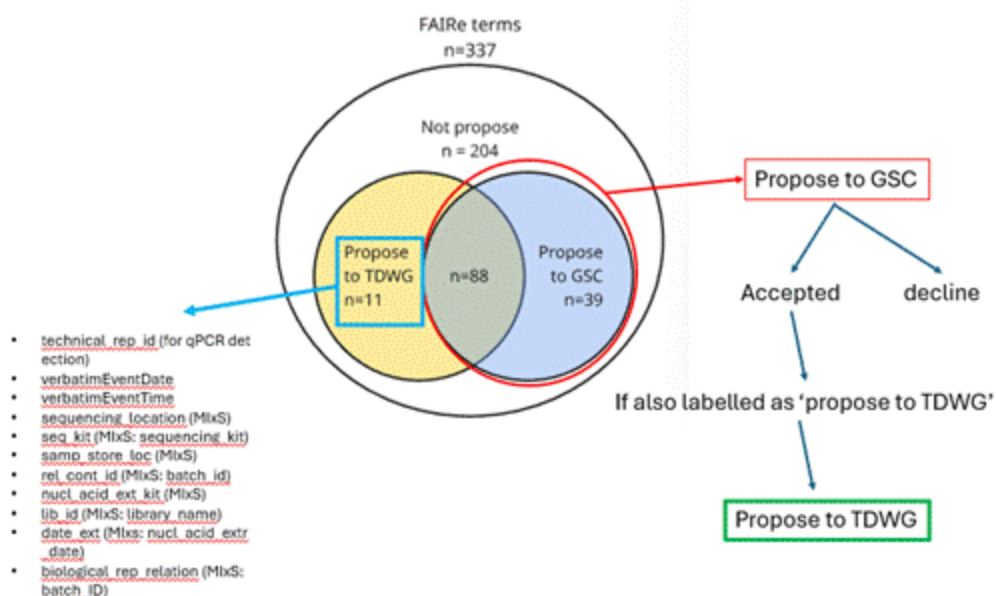
- C. Issues that were part of the previous review, but which had not achieved consensus after the first 30 days were automatically pushed into this review by removing them from the "First post-DwC-DP release" milestone and placing them in the "Next public review 2026".
- D. Old issues that were unresolved have been resurrected for another try.
- E. Other new issues that have been assessed as meeting the three required criteria have also been added. I have omitted the RASD proposals because they still need work and possibly an Implementation Experience Report since they are a coordinated addition.
- F. Link for issues currently in the "Next public review 2026" milestone:
<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues?q=is%3Aissue+state%3Aopen+milestone%3A%22Next+public+review+2026%22>
- G. Link for open issues remaining after screening out issues that don't qualify for this review for various reasons:
<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues?q=is%3Aissue+state%3Aopen+-milestone%3A%22First+post-DwC-DP+release%22+-milestone%3A%22Next+public+review+2026%22+-label%3A%22Class+-+RASD+Reason%22+-label%3A%22Class+-+RASD+Treatment%22+-label%3A%22Process+-+needs+Task+Group%22+-label%3A%22Issue+Summary%22+-parent-issue%3Atdwg%2Fdwc%231064+-label%3A%22Task+Group+-+Biome+and+Realm%22>
- H. Discussion and approval of issues to be included in the upcoming review.
 - 1. I think issue #835 needs MiXS/DwC coordination. Is it ready or do we bump it off another 4 months? yes if ready by Nov 1
 - a) <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/835#issuecomment-599485466>
 - 2. <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/1042> needs an actual proposal. El-Amine Mimouni says he will contribute to drafting one. If ready by Nov 1
 - a) Agreed by group to include it
 - 3. Need definitions for materialEntityCategory controlled values
<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/1054>
 - a) Agreed by group to include it. Erica and Ben will add vocab.
 - 4. Issue #883 <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/883> does not yet have a clear proposal about creating a survey core.
 - a) Agreed by group to defer it to the next milestone. John: we need an extension proposal first.
 - 5. Issue #899 <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/899> moved forward from the last milestone and seems near consensus
 - a) Agreed by group to include it.
 - 6. Issue #925 <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/925> has been revised by Steve
 - a) Agreed by group to include it, but a subissue should be made for each affected term. Steve will do this (referring to the parent issue for the text that is the same for all).

7. A number of proposals tagged as "Unresolved" or "Controversial" in the past have been moved into this milestone for another try at consensus.
8. New proposals added to the milestone:
<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/886>
 - Agreed by group to defer it to the next milestone. Ask Ian for additional demand justification. Should likely also not be organized in Organism class?
<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/1046>
 - John thinks this has already been gone through. **Action:** He will investigate.
<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/1060>
 - Change is whether this should be added to the conceptual model. Agreed by group to include it.

- V. Discussion of policy to use lowerCamelCase for controlled value strings
 - A. Refer to Issue 794 and 788:
<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/794#issuecomment-5310934668>
<https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/788#issuecomment-5288823019>
 - B. Presentation by Steve on past practice
 - C. Discussion and decision about whether to formalize this policy.

Decided to defer this to next meeting

- VI. Presentation about a Material Core and new terms "material form" and "material subcategory". (Ben)
<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1DJfrLpNA96zO2bzU6mfODwoojKF1t8HXnWa0dHctrsE/edit?tab=t.0>
We'll revisit this in the next meeting as well.
- VII. Other business
 - A. eDNA TG/FAIReDNA proposal graphic:



We asked Cecilie to let the task group know that they should get their term proposals in the tracker by 2 weeks ahead of the November 1 start date for the public review (November 18). The term proposals will be put under an umbrella issue and Steve will ask MG members via the email list to give a thumbs up or down to a comment on the umbrella issue that asks whether the proposals meet the three readiness requirements. If there are questions about the readiness of the proposal (thumbs down), then the proposal will be deferred to the next review cycle.